



Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Dear Friend of Charles Street:

At long last, the Charles Street Byway Management Plan is now underway. This is a once-in-a-hundred-year opportunity and we need your help:

- to lead Baltimore's tourists to a collection of the wonders of Baltimore beyond the Inner Harbor
- to strengthen the spine that can effectively link many of Baltimore's cultural heritage resources
- to look at and think about Charles Street as a whole and make the fixes to the driving experience for both tourists and residents that have never happened because no one has ever focused on them
- to build another link between Baltimore City and Baltimore County
- to access new Federal and State dollars to make important improvements to the street and corridor
- to help protect and promote the unique qualities of the Charles Street corridor
- to build a plan which helps balance development, conservation, tourism, and economic uses of the land along the corridor
- to develop a national model for an urban scenic byway
- to get all kinds of people all along the corridor working together on something they care about



The Byway Management Plan is needed to gain National Scenic Byway designation for Charles Street through the Federal Highway Administration's (FHWA) National Scenic Byway Program. The designation is sought to assist the City and the County in their efforts to both preserve and promote the rich historic and cultural heritage of Charles Street, Baltimore's premier street and best known artery—home to many of Baltimore's most important institutions and memories.

Over the last two years Baltimore City and Baltimore County have formed a management committee to develop a scope of work for the plan and hire a consultant to assist in the preparation of the byway management plan. The City has hired the team of Johnson, Mirmiran & Thompson, a multi-disciplined engineering firm from Sparks, Maryland, and Lardner/Klein Landscape

Architects, a nationally recognized firm with expertise in byway management planning from Alexandria, Virginia.

Funds for the planning effort come from the Federal Highway Administration's Scenic Byway Program. At the end of the management planning process, the citizens and neighbors that live, work, or otherwise enjoy Charles Street will decide whether to pursue designation as a National Scenic Byway through FHWA's National Scenic Byway program.

Whether or not such designation is achieved, the management planning effort will provide us with an important opportunity to plan for the future of Charles Street.

The most important aspect of the planning effort is the need to develop a collaborative process that encourages the active involvement of each and every

person with an interest in the future of Charles Street and to make that involvement an enjoyable and worthwhile experience. While it is not possible to involve every person directly in every decision, it is possible to set up a process whereby each point of view, each community group, and each type of potential user are all represented in the decision-making process.

The Charles Street Byway Management Plan Advisory Group

The Advisory Group will meet a total of seven times over the next ten to twelve months at different locations along the corridor. In addition there will be two public meetings: one to provide more information to the public about the planning effort and to review the plan's vision, goals, and objectives; and a second meeting to review the plan's recommended strategies for preserving and enhancing the Byway's heritage resources and tourism development opportunities. If the Advisory Group recommends pursuing designation as a National Scenic Byway, then a permanent advisory group will be formed to implement the plan.

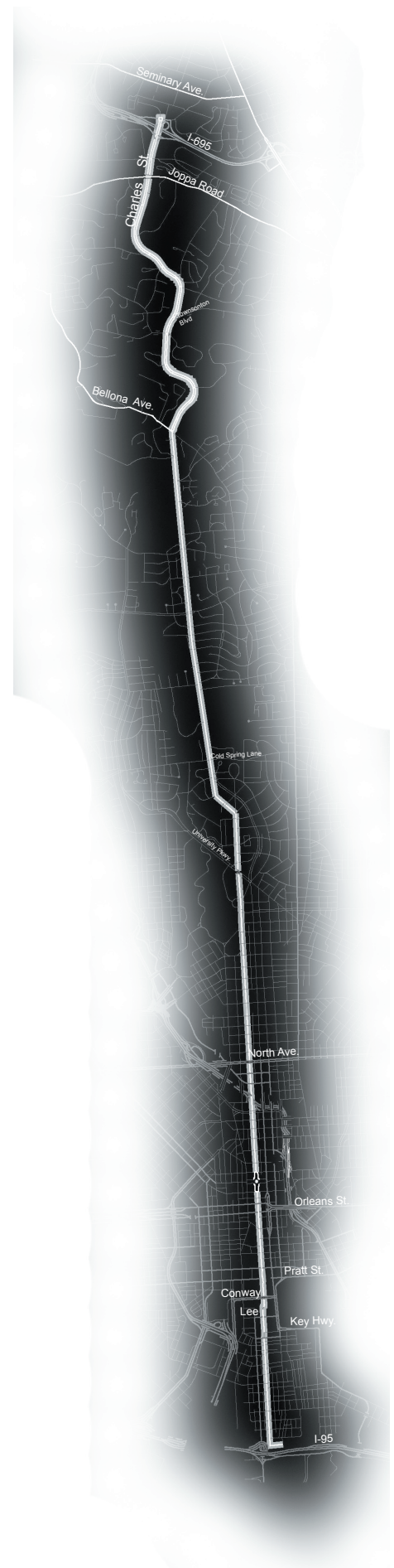
All meetings of the Advisory Group are open to the public and all are welcome to attend and participate. The tentative schedule of Advisory Group meetings, their topics, as well as community-wide public meetings (workshops) are as follows:

Mtg #	Purpose	Tentative Date
1	Vision and Goals	February 16
2	Corridor Definition	March 16
*	<i>Community Workshops</i>	<i>April 20</i>
3	Intrinsic Qualities	May 18
4	Preservation Strategies	June 15
5.	Enhancement Strategies	August 17
6.	Transportation/Roadside Management	September 21
*	<i>Community Workshops</i>	<i>October 19</i>
7.	Draft Plan Follow-up	November 16
	Final Plan	December 14
	Submit Nomination	Early 2006

Where can I get more information about the plan?

Please call, write, or email Jim Hall, the Project Manager for the City. He may be contacted at:

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CHARLES STREET BYWAY MANAGEMENT PLAN

Strategies for Enhancing the Visitor Experience: Wayfinding and Interpretation

1. Make it easier to find the byway in South Baltimore–

Install byway specific wayfinding signs in South Baltimore as follows:

Priority 1: From I-95 Southbound to Key Highway to Fort Avenue into South Baltimore

Priority 2: From the Inner Harbor Visitor Center to Cross Street Market via Light Street and _____ (pick one of three choices)

Priority 3: From the Baltimore Washington Parkway and Russell Street to the Cross Street Market via W Hamburg (right on Charles)

2. Make it easier to find the byway from I-695 at Charles and improve the overall quality of the experience of the North Charles Street section of the Byway

The wayfinding portion of this strategy includes the following recommendations:

- Direct byway visitors from the Baltimore Beltway to a new visitor information kiosk (the location of which is still to be determined -- see previous discussion of enhancement strategies and requiring coordination with the Charles Street Interchange/Beltway Widening project)
- Direct visitors from the visitor information kiosk to key sites along North Charles (Lutherville, Sheppard Pratt, etc.)

3. Develop visitor information kiosks at key connection points along the byway:

- Cross Street Market
- Inner Harbor
- Downtown (suggest at Charles Center)
- Mt. Vernon Square vicinity
- Penn Station
- JHU (recommend at 33rd St.)
- North Charles Gateway

Strategies for Enhancing the Visitor Experience: Interpretation

4. Develop a series of themed walking tours/itineraries to expand existing offerings along Charles Street – starting all walking tours at locations noted above

Existing Walking Tours:

Mount Vernon Place Walking Tour

Explore Mount Vernon Place; the best-preserved 19th century urban square in the country, hearing the fascinating story of the wealthy and fashionable residents who built the first public monument in the nation and the elegant buildings that surround it.

http://www.baltimore.org/visitors/v_wt_arch_mtv.html

Federal Hill-Otterbein Holiday Tours, a house tour offered in mid-December, enables visitors to see inside the homes in these two historic neighborhoods just south of downtown. Call tel. **410/332-0783** for details or visit www.federalhill.org.

Also see Shrivvers, Walking in Baltimore

Walking Tours on the Drawing Board

- Heritage Area Walk expansion?
- Sheppard Pratt

Recommendations for New Walking Tours/Itineraries Along Charles Street

A series of walking/touring guides should be developed around a specific set of themes (all associated with the primary theme of “Urban Innovation along the shores of the Chesapeake”)

1. Innovations in Architecture: The Row House
2. Innovations in Architecture: Architectural Icons
3. Innovations in Architecture: Houses of Worship
4. Innovations in Education and Philanthropy

Itinerary #1: Innovations in Housing: the Baltimore Rowhouse

Consider using themes from Mary Ellen Hayward and Charles Belfour book “the Baltimore Rowhouse”

- 1) The Walking City: 1790-1855
- 2) The Italianate Period (1850-1890)
- 3) The Artistic Period (1875-1915)
- 4) The Daylight Rowhouse (1915-1955)
- 5) The Rowhouse Returns: (1970s-1990s)

300 Block of N. Charles at Saratoga – three blocks of almost uninterrupted rowhouses little changed since 1830 except for shop windows inserted a century ago.

Browns Arcade (326 – dating from 1830s)

Belvedere Row – an entire block of Queen Anne-style row houses.

Itinerary #2: Architectural Icons

Architectural interest viewed from the street

Iron, man! Checkout the Baltimore-made ironwork at the Peabody Library, Washington Monument and all along Charles Street.

Hansa House 		Distinguished by its German lodge-like design. It was built in 1907 for the North German Lloyd Steamship Company, a company responsible for bringing millions of immigrants into the port and the nation. It was owned by the Savings Bank of Baltimore in the 1970s, became a satellite to the Baltimore Museum of Art in the 1980's and recently has been the site of a financial company.	Located on the corner of Redwood and Charles streets (DSCN 6232)
The Basilica of the Assumption 		The Basilica is the first Roman Catholic Cathedral in the United States. The cornerstone was blessed by Bishop John Carroll in 1806 and dedicated by Ambrose Marechal in 1821. The Basilica, designed by Benjamin Latrobe, architect of the nation's capitol, is one of the finest examples of neo-classical architecture in the world.	Cathedral and Mulberry Streets Baltimore, MD21201 410-727-3565 www.baltimorebasilica.org Tours Sunday after 10:45am Mass and by appointment.
Garrett Jacobs Mansion 		The Garrett Jacobs Mansion is the grandest townhouse in Baltimore, the work of two famous architects, Stanford White and John Russell Pope. The home of Mrs. Robert Garrett (later Jacobs), it boasts 40 rooms, 100 windows, 16 fireplaces, a curved staircase topped by a Tiffany glass dome, carved paneling, a ballroom, a "supper room" serving 100, an art gallery and a covered conservatory. DSCN6214	11 West Mount Vernon Place Baltimore, MD21201 410-539-6914 www.garrettjacobsmanion.org Tours Mondays at 3pm, reservations required.
Pennsylvania Station 		Constructed over the tracks of the Pennsylvania Railroad in 1910. Built in a grand style, the station is an architectural marvel of marble, mahogany, bronze, mosaic tiles, and leaded glass and a symbol of Baltimore's importance as a direct connection to the nation's other great cities.	

Itinerary #3: Houses of Worship

Another architecturally significant group along the Byway is the vast and diverse populations of Houses of Worship. There are many 'oldest' or 'firsts' in the nation along Charles Street in this category. To highlight a few from south to north:

Ebenezer AME:	National Register of Historic Places	the oldest church in Baltimore built and continuously occupied by the same African American congregation (DSCN 6263).	(http://www.southbaltimore.com/church/) Located on Montgomery Street, all are welcome to the church services and meetings.
Otterbein United Methodist: 		the only eighteenth-century constructed house of worship in Baltimore still active as a church. (DSCN 6264-6266) and is It is the Mother Church of the Church of the United Brethren, a Methodist branch.	This church is located on Conway Street. According to the Church's website, "visitors are welcome to Sunday morning worship services at 11:00 a.m. The church is also open on Saturdays, April to October, 10:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. To make arrangements for tours at other times, contact J. William Joynes." (http://www.southbaltimore.com/church/Otterbein/otterbein3.html)
St. Paul's Episcopal 		(DSCN 1933) the current building is the 4 th church of this name on the site. It is an Italian Romanesque style church and was constructed in 1856 by architect Richard Upjohn. The Parish was founded in 1692 as the "Mother Church of Baltimore Episcopalians."	Located at Charles and Saratoga Street in the Business and Government District,
First Unitarian 		(DSCN 6204), the First Unitarian Church was designed in the romantic classical style by French architect, Maximilien Godfroy. It was to be a signature specimen of architecture in Baltimore in 1818. The church has historical connections to people, specifically, Sparks, Enoch Pratt, George Peabody and Rembrandt Peale.	Located at Franklin and Charles Streets
Mt. Vernon Place United Methodist 		(DSCN 1921) It was constructed in 1872 on the site of the former mansion of John Eager Howard's son, Charles, who was married to Francis Scott Key's daughter. The architecture of the church is unique in its gothic style and green stone. From: Shivers, Frank R. Jr. <i>Walking in Baltimore</i> , Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1995.	This is most elaborate church at Mount Vernon Place.
Basilica of the Assumption 	National Register of Historic Places	(DSCN 1924, 6199) This Church is the first Roman Catholic Cathedral built in the US. Its classical style was designed by Benjamin Latrobe and was consecrated in 1821. There have been ten Provincial and three Plenary Councils held in the Basilica and thirty bishops have been consecrated there. In 1937 Pope XI elevated the Cathedral to a minor Basilica because of its significance within the history of the Church. It is on the National Registry of Historic Places.	The Basilica is currently undergoing restorations and is closed until late summer of 2006. (http://www.baltimorebasilica.org/index2.html)
Stony Run Friends		(DSCN 6248/6249) A Quaker presence has been in Baltimore since 1792. The first meetinghouse was located at	Anyone is welcome to join the meetings and there is a library associated with the Meetinghouse. It is open whenever the office is open (generally 9:30 a.m. to 3:00

		Aisquith and Fayette Streets near the Harbor, but soon became too small. Years later, in 1944 a group of Friends opened the Stony Run Friends meeting house on Charles St.	p.m. weekdays, and Sundays 9:15 to 1:00 p.m) (http://www.stonyrunfriends.org/QuakerPresence.html)
Cathedral of Mary Our Queen 		(DSCN 5338-5341) Located on the northern part of Charles Street, the Church is reminiscent of great European cathedrals. It is full of stained glass windows, artwork and statues all designed to teach faith.	(http://cathedralofmary.org/cathedral/index.html) The church is open daily to visitors 7 am-8 pm.
Lovely Lane 		(DSCN 6233-6234) the church was built between 1882-1887 and designed by Stanford White. Dr. John F. Goucher, who also founded Goucher College, was the pastor at the time the church was built. It is now referred to as the "Mother Church of American Methodism" and also houses a Methodism museum in the building. The Romanesque church building was built, (circa 1884), as a "centennial monument" marking the founding of the Methodist Episcopal Church in Baltimore at the Lovely Lane Meeting House.	23rd Street, a block to the right on St. Paul Street. Guided tours of the Church and Museum are available with advance notice, and on Sundays immediately following morning worship. (http://www.lovelylane.net/)

Itinerary #4: Innovations in Urban Development

Additional and notable buildings and designed places visible from the street that should be part of the guidebook:

Inner Harbor			
Charles Center 		highrise office building is Mies Van der Rohe's signature building for the Charles Center Revitalization Project. Built in 1962 this concrete, glass and aluminum building stands out as a mid-century modern monolith amongst the smaller buildings of the 1900's. (DSCN 1934)	
Mount Vernon Place / Washington Monument (DSCN 6210)		the first urban monument to George Washington when it was constructed in 1815.	
Charles Village,		developed in the late 19th-century as one of the city's first suburban neighborhoods.	
Roland Park		(early Garden Suburb)	
Guilford			

Itinerary #5: Innovations in Education and Philanthropy

Enoch Pratt Free Library 		(DSCN 6201)	
Walters Art Museum 		(DSCN 6207)	
Peabody Institute 		(DSCN 6212) – Peabody Institute was designed by Edmund Lind.	
Johns Hopkins University		More than 20 Georgian-style buildings make up the 100-acre campus of lawns, woodlands, and parks that was once the estate of Charles Carroll of Carrollton, a signer of the Declaration of Independence. Built in 1803, Homewood has been described as the most refined Federal-period country house in Baltimore. The mansion has been restored and is now a museum.	
Evergreen House		Set back from the street on a wooded knoll, this magnificent Italianate home, once owned by the prominent Garrett family, now belongs to Johns Hopkins University and houses a museum, library, concert hall, and meeting rooms. The house and museum shop are open to the public.	6500
Sheppard Pratt	National Historic Landmarks	Sheppard and Enoch Pratt Hospital, a private institution founded in 1857 for the treatment of mental and nervous disorders. New York architect Calvert Vaux designed the hospital's main buildings, which have been designated	
Art Museum Drive		named for its principal landmark, the Baltimore Museum of Art, Maryland's largest art museum. Designed	

		by John Pope and Howard Sill, the city-owned museum is an impressive neoclassic building housing an extensive “collection of collections.”	
Friends School of Baltimore		Founded in 1784, it is the oldest school in Baltimore.	

Charles Street

Existing Sidetracks as published in SHA Scenic Byway Guidebook:

Sidetrack: For a quick tour of the rehabilitated neighborhood of Otterbein, turn left at Lee Street, right at Sharp Street, right again on Conway Street, and then left to return to Charles Street. One of the nation's most successful examples of "urban homesteading," Otterbein is the location of the Old Otterbein United Methodist Church, the oldest church building in Baltimore.

Sidetrack: Turn left on Art Museum Drive and left again on Wyman Park Drive, which winds through Wyman Park and across the JFX to Druid Hill Park. Baltimore City purchased the Druid Hill Estate in 1801. Nicholas Rogers, who served during the American Revolution, built the Federal-style mansion and modeled the landscaping after private parks he had seen in England. At mid-century, the city hired the Olmsted Brothers firm of nationally acclaimed landscape architects to create a comprehensive plan for the city's park system. Druid Hill Park is a prime example of the urban park movement that emerged in Baltimore and other eastern cities at that time. Among the additions over the years were Druid Lake, a Victorian conservatory, statues, picnic areas, pathways, playing fields, and a swimming pool. Within the park is the Baltimore Zoo, the third-oldest zoo in the United States and home to more than 2,250 animals, birds, and reptiles. The original Rogers Mansion, now zoo offices, overlooks the park.

Sidetrack: From Charles Street turn left on University Parkway, which becomes Roland Avenue and takes you to Roland Park, a late 19th-century residential community of some 2,500 homes. Elegant villas and mansions line Roland Park's winding narrow streets where the Roland Park Shopping Center pioneered as the nation's first suburban shopping center. On the campus of Johns Hopkins University, on University Parkway, the Lacrosse Hall of Fame Museum honors America's first sport.

Sidetrack: Turn right on Bellona Avenue and follow it across Seminary Avenue into Lutherville, a residential community that mixes past and present. The historic district has approximately 80 historic structures. Founded by Lutheran clergy, the town was the site of the Lutherville Female Seminary, an early woman's college. When Lutherville became a stop on the Northern Central Railroad, it drew summer residents and those willing to commute to offices and jobs in Baltimore. The former seminary is now a nursing home, which you will find by making a left turn on Seminary Avenue west.



Number Five

Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Traveling along the Byway

There are fourteen requirements for corridor management plans that must be met for a scenic road to be designated as a National Scenic Byway. Of the fourteen, four are specific to traveling along the Byway:

- A general review of the road's or highway's safety and accident record to identify any correctable faults in highway design, maintenance, or operation.
- A plan to accommodate commerce while maintaining a safe and efficient level of highway service, including convenient user facilities.
- A signage plan that demonstrates how the State (and City) will insure and make the number and placement of signs more supportive of the visitor experience.
- A discussion of design standards relating to any proposed modification of the roadway. This discussion should include an evaluation of how the proposed changes may affect on the intrinsic qualities of the byway corridor.

Charles Street has benefitted from a series of streetscape projects throughout the downtown and Mt. Vernon areas, including pedestrian oriented wayfinding. The City and the neighborhoods around Johns Hopkins recently agreed on a concept for streetscape and safety improvements between 25th and University Avenue. A streetscape project was also initiated at Woodbrook. The Charles Street Development Corporation has proposed a "circular system" to connect the Inner Harbor with various destinations along Charles Street.

Additional work is now needed to extend these efforts to other parts of the Byway to: 1) create a safe, clean, walkable, and pedestrian friendly environment along its entire length; 2) make it easier and safer to travel the Byway by bicycle; and, 3) make it easier and safer to find your way along the Byway by automobile by improving signage, wayfinding, and the visual identity of Charles Street. This planning effort is an excellent opportunity to make Charles Street the most "multi-modal" byway in the country.

Preliminary Strategies

The attached table identifies a preliminary list of transportation strategies designed to achieve both a safe and attractive route for visitors and residents alike. The following key projects are included in the strategies:

- Establish well signed and intuitive routes to access and travel along the Byway by all modes of travel;
- Establish easily identifiable gateways and "urban trailheads" in South Baltimore, the Inner Harbor, Mt. Vernon, Penn Station, and at I-695/ Lutherville;
- Establish a continuous, lighted, sidewalk along both sides of the entire length of Charles Street;
- Reestablish a continuous bicycle route along or parallel to Charles Street;
- Improve the safety of left turns north of University through the introduction of new landscaped medians and protected turn lanes.



Providing more space for pedestrians and bicycles while preserving the green edge along the northern part of Charles Street (top) is one of the biggest challenges for the byway effort. Providing a landscaped median for protected left turns and as a pedestrian refuge halfway across Charles is also a critical need, especially in the vicinity of the schools and institutions north of University Avenue (middle). Adjustments also need to be made at the Charles and St. Paul one-way split to make it easier to follow the route (bottom).

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Number Two

Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Defining the Charles Street Corridor

Defining the Byway corridor is one of the most critical elements in developing a Byway management plan. A narrow corridor definition would limit the number of areas eligible to apply for Scenic Byway funds, while an overly inclusive corridor definition will dissipate planning and implementation efforts.

- The Byway corridor should include the whole length of Charles Street and portions of any parallel street required to create a return path. The Byway will extend from the Charles Street-Beltway traffic circle in Lutherville to the end of Charles Street in South Baltimore, just below the Beltway viaduct.
- The width of the Byway will be defined by the “viewshed,” or, the elements that are visible from the roadway itself. This width will vary, from the narrowly defined visual experience of urban Mount Vernon to the expansive width of the Byway through the lawns and woods of Baltimore County.
- Sidetracks will include streets, environments, and attractions that will help tell the Byway story. The attractions must also be visitor-ready with available parking and access to alternative transportation modes. Sidetracks may also create a loop or a logical link to or from the primary Charles Street corridor.

The map on the reverse side shows the location of the Byway in relation to existing and planned greenways, trails, scenic byways, and potential gateways.

Byway Theme

A theme for the Charles Street Byway is critical to the organization of the

planning, implementation, and finally, the quality of the experience for its future visitors. Adapting a theme identified by the Baltimore City Heritage Area Authority has tremendous potential for Charles Street and is a good starting point as we think about the corridor.

“As Baltimore’s main street and premier avenue, Charles Street tells a tale of urban innovation on the shores of the Chesapeake. Countless stories are illustrated along this corridor: the invention and morphing of the North American rowhouse, from alley houses to mansions, with their streets punctuated by steeples in all directions, and the creation of Olmstedian greenswards in North Baltimore. We’ve done reinvention, too: memorable preservation efforts in Otterbein and Federal Hill; a total transformation of the Upper Basin of the Patapsco into the Inner Harbor; and the pioneering endeavors in modernist planning at Charles Center. From port to portico, dollar house to movie house, Charles Street ties together the architectural, cultural, institutional, and historical legacy of Baltimore.”

Byway Vision

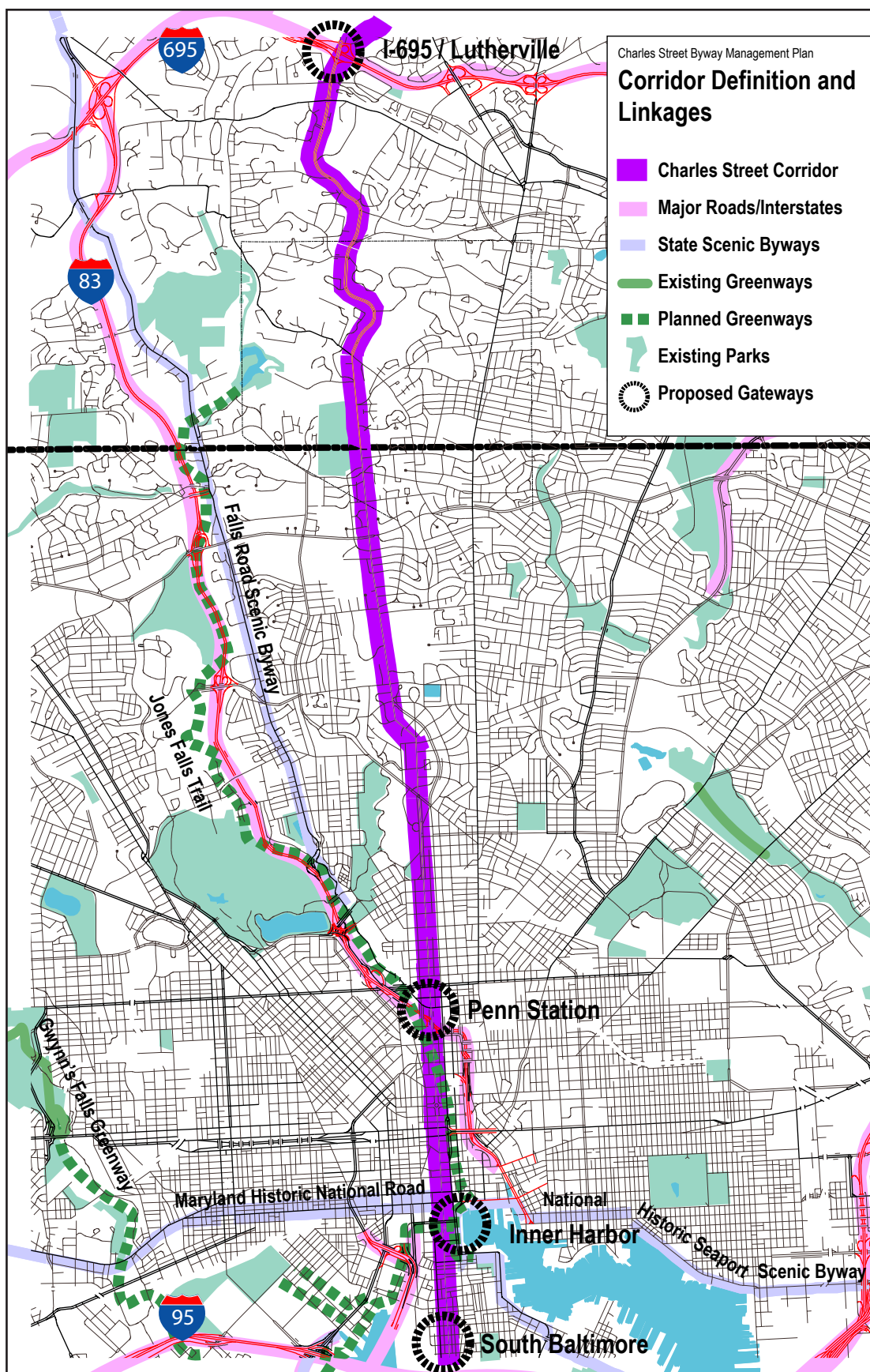
The Byway vision is intended to guide the development of the corridor plan. The following statement was derived from Advisory Committee input:

“Arriving by train, car, boat, bicycle, bus, light rail, and on foot, visitors



The “viewshed” of Charles Street is bounded by building facades in its urban neighborhoods (top) and more expansive landscapes found in the northern part of the corridor (bottom photograph).

to the Byway experience a vibrant cultural landscape unique to the Chesapeake region. Linking the Inner Harbor and its attractions to many of Baltimore’s outstanding and world-renowned educational, historical, and cultural institutions, the Byway travels through an eclectic mix of urban and suburban neighborhoods, great places to live, work, shop, dine, recreate, and relax. The variety of Charles Street makes for an interesting experience as residents and visitors alike travel between the City and County, enjoying Baltimore’s wonderful museums, historical sites, architectural beauty, cultural activities and its designed landscapes and parks.”



For more information: Please call, write, or email Jim Hall, the Project Manager for the City at:
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Number Three

Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Byway Planning Workshop Summary

A Byway planning workshop was held on April 18, 2005 to reach out to our neighbors, colleagues, and others with an interest in Charles Street. The goal of the meeting was to gather citizen input and let everyone know where we are heading with the Byway planning effort. The workshop also served as a great opportunity for those who are interested in Charles Street to help set the direction of the plan.

Participants at the workshop reviewed and evaluated an initial list of Byway management ideas developed by the Advisory Committee to let us know which ideas were of the greatest importance and which ideas were of a lower priority.

After compiling the list of ideas and sorting the list by priority, some common ideas emerged that will help us focus the Charles Street Byway Management Plan. These ideas fall into three basic categories:

- Physical improvements and enhancements
- Preservation/conservation actions and activities
- Management activities



Physical Improvements and Enhancements

One of the most commonly expressed concerns was the need to make improvements along Charles Street that facilitates access to transit, improves traffic conditions, and creates a more appealing streetscape. Widely supported ideas include:

- Improving access to mass transit and promoting clean, user-friendly public transit that appeals to residents, tourists, shoppers and workers
- Improving the traffic flow while minimizing impact on neighborhoods
- Improving safety of left-turn movements
- Slowing speed through the corridor
- Making the corridor more pedestrian-friendly, including widening sidewalks, adding buffers between cars and pedestrians and other physical improvements to the right-of-way
- Identifying potential interpretive sites and opportunities
- Extending the existing pedestrian wayfinding system to the north and south of downtown, Mount Vernon and the Inner Harbor
- Planting more trees, improving the environment for growing trees, and doing a better job of maintaining existing trees along Charles Street
- Extending streetscape improvements throughout the corridor and increasing the number of historic street lighting fixtures
- Making it easier for visitors to find their way to South Baltimore in a manner that will not increase commuter traffic

Workshop participants also made it clear that they did not want to make any changes that would increase automobile, bus and tour bus traffic through the corridor. Concerns arose regarding the proposed Inner Harbor – University Parkway trolley system, as well as the establishment of a northern gateway at I-695 and the reallocation of pavement to provide more space for pedestrians and bicyclists.



Preservation/Conservation Actions

Workshop participants widely supported the goal of preserving the special qualities of Charles Street that establish it as one of the Baltimore Region's premier streets, including its many unique and special historic sites as well as the landscape fabric of its great and varied urban, institutional and suburban neighborhoods. The highest priorities fell into three general areas:

- Development of guidelines to guide future changes along the Charles Street corridor
- Education of homeowners and property owners about the historical significance of the Charles Street corridor for the purpose of protecting and promoting sound improvements and/or restorations
- Enhancement of the overall appearance of the corridor including a consideration to return to Olmstedian design principles.

Workshop participants expressed concerns about misapplying Olmsted's principles, especially in the boulevard section of Charles Street where Olmsted's recommendations were never originally followed. Further work will determine the best way to acknowledge the original Olmsted plan in our planning for Charles Street.

Management Actions

Workshop participants recognized the need for better coordination among all stakeholders to influence the use and future appearance of Charles Street. The highest priorities are:

- Developing a Byway-specific brochure for touring the Byway via bus, transit, bicycle and foot
- Cleaning up and improving the trash removal along the street and corridor
- Working with existing neighborhood and other local organizations

Concerns arose regarding the establishment of a system of visitor centers and kiosks along Charles Street, particularly at the northern gateway area in Lutherville where more outreach will be needed to discuss the concept with residents so they might understand how the Byway can improve the quality of their community.

Additional historic sites and interpretive opportunities were also identified, including some corrections that will be made to the inventory map. This map, which will be made part of an existing conditions report, will document existing conditions along the corridor. This report will document what we have learned about Charles Street so far.

Next Steps

Over the next several months, we will look at the range of ideas presented in greater detail, refine the strategies to address concerns and determine who will be responsible for implementing the management strategies. The next four Advisory Committee meetings will be used to accomplish these goals. A second public workshop is scheduled for the fall 2005. Thank you to all those that participated in the workshop. We look forward to your continued involvement!

For more information: Please call, write, or email Jim Hall, the Project Manager for the City at:
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Memorandum

To: Charles Street Byway Advisory Committee
cc: Jim Hall, David Streathy, Lynn Lanham, Jenifer German
From: Jim Klein
Re: Preliminary Outline of Byway Management Strategies
Part 1: Preservation and related enhancement strategies
Date: May 31, 2005

Overview of Strategy Development and Needs

The following preliminary list of byway management strategies [Part 1 of 4] have been identified as potential solutions to issues raised by the advisory committee or the public as needing to be addressed as part of the byway management plan. The preliminary list has been created from the input provided by the Advisory Committee at its first three meetings along with input provided at the April 20 public workshop on byway management planning.

The strategies are organized by four major categories listed below according to the requirements of a corridor management plan for designation as a National Scenic Byway from the Federal Highway Administration (*italicized*). The numbers in parenthesis refer to one of the fourteen requirements of a corridor management plan required for designation as a National Scenic Byway from the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA).

Please note that some of the projects listed are already underway, some have a high probability of being implemented quickly, and others should probably be considered as longer-term projects. The following is a brief assessment of the the types of byway management strategies that will be needed for designation for each of four categories include:

Preservation and Enhancement of the Byway (June 15th Meeting Agenda)

- (1) A map identifying the corridor boundaries and the location of intrinsic qualities and different land uses within the corridor.*
- (2) An assessment of such intrinsic qualities and of their context.*
- (3) A strategy for maintaining and enhancing those intrinsic qualities.*
- (5) A strategy describing how existing development might be enhanced and new development might be accommodated while still preserving the intrinsic qualities of the corridor.*
- (9) A demonstration that intrusions on the visitor experience have been minimized to the extent feasible, and a plan for making improvements to enhance that experience.*

Much of the byway is already designated as either a local, state or federal historic district or historic site. However, only two of the historic districts have adopted guidelines for accommodating new development. Additional efforts will be needed to guide future development in a manner that will be compatible with the intrinsic qualities.

In addition, efforts are needed to accelerate existing planned or programmed enhancement projects to ensure that they are implemented in a timely manner and to address the issue of the need to minimize intrusions on the visitor experience. Additional strategies are also needed to better maintain the urban forest and green infrastructure along Charles Street, and to improve the overall cleanliness and 'curb appeal' of all the neighborhoods along Charles Street.

Traveling along the Byway (August 17th Meeting Agenda)

(7) A general review of the road's or highway's safety and accident record to identify any correctable faults in highway design, maintenance, or operation.

(8) A plan to accommodate commerce while maintaining a safe and efficient level of highway service, including convenient user facilities.

*(11) A signage plan that demonstrates how the State **(and City)** will insure and make the number and placement of signs more supportive of the visitor experience.*

(13) A discussion of design standards relating to any proposed modification of the roadway. This discussion should include an evaluation of how the proposed changes may affect on the intrinsic qualities of the byway corridor.

A safe travel experience influences the overall quality of the experience. Improving road safety must be compatible with goals for enhancing roadside character. A safe and attractive route can be achieved by working proactively with the City of Baltimore Department of Transportation and the Maryland State Highway Administration (SHA) to accommodate and balance the unique needs of all the roadway users including residents, commercial and recreational users, businesses dependent upon access, pedestrians, and transit.

The Byway's Visitor Experience (September 21 Agenda)

(12) A narrative describing how the National Scenic Byway will be positioned for marketing.

(14) A description of plans to interpret the significant resources of the scenic byway.

The goal of the Charles Street Byway is to both increase the number of visitors and increase the length of a visitor's stay. At the same time, the potential impact of increased visitor activity must be carefully managed so as to not detract from the quality of visitor experience and existing neighborhoods, community facilities and services.

Telling a clear and compelling "story" along the byway is one way to encourage people to linger longer along the byway. The byway effort will focus on working with the existing historic sites, museums, gardens and parks.

Coordination and Management (October 19 agenda)

(4) A schedule and a listing of all agency, group, and individual responsibilities in the implementation of the corridor management plan, and a description of enforcement and review mechanisms, including a schedule for the continuing review of how well those responsibilities are being met.

(6) A plan to assure on-going public participation in the implementation of corridor management objectives.

Ensuring that the plan moves forward requires that a permanent "management entity" be established to coordinate and implement the corridor plan as it develops.

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Byway Preservation and Enhancement:				
GOAL - Preserve particularly vulnerable and high priority historic structures, sites and landscapes through the use of conservation or preservation easements				
Amend the City and County Comprehensive Plans to acknowledge and recognize the preservation needs of the Charles Street Byway as a means of demonstrating the significant public benefit of the byway and to establish a preservation purpose for its historic qualities.	Entire Byway	City of Baltimore Baltimore County		
Appoint a "Byway Keeper" to carry out the directives of the Charles Street Byway Management Entity. The "Byway Keeper" will be responsible for monitoring the status of historic sites and landscapes identified as conservation and preservation priorities and work with property owners and preservation organizations on a byway specific conservation and preservation easement program. The Byway Keeper will monitor development activity and distribute educational materials to developers.	Entire Byway		\$25,000 per year for five years	Available as "seed grant" once designated as a National Scenic Byway. Should consider using funds to augment an existing position within local government or non-profit organization.
Develop educational materials and a property owner information package to facilitate the donation and/or purchase of preservation easements for willing property owners	Entire Byway	Consider formation of urban open space conservancy or linking to an existing land trust		
Seek and support opportunities to make preservation funding sources available to property owners to facilitate easements and acquisition. Establish a revolving fund for preservation actions.	Entire Byway			
Develop a "Byway Stewardship Recognition Program" to recognize those individuals that donate preservation easements or otherwise voluntarily protect their lands and buildings in a manner that preserves the byway's intrinsic	Entire Byway			

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
qualities.				
Byway Preservation and Enhancement:				
GOAL – Maintain the overall character and quality of the Charles Street Byway through the use of simple and easy to understand design and development guidelines				
Develop a simple and easy to use set of byway design and management guidelines for use by property owners along the byway as a means of maintaining and/or enhancing the byway's distinguishing intrinsic qualities. Byway design and management guidelines should be developed as a means of communicating to adjacent property owners along Charles Street, the ways in which their project or activity can contribute positively to the overall experience of Charles Street as Baltimore's premiere street. The Byway Guidelines should work in tandem with existing guidelines and be based on the following existing guidelines already in use: - Existing Building Construction – utilize the existing CHAP guidelines in an advisory capacity - New construction – utilize the Mt. Vernon URP guidelines in an advisory capacity - County scenic road guidelines augmented with additional recommendations for roadway and related open spaces - Landscape – develop additional guidelines focusing on the roadway and streetscape areas and related open spaces. Consult the Valley's Planning Council landscape guidelines for format and approach <u>Byway and Community Context</u> Projects should respond proactively to the visual and spatial relationships inherent to the project site including the special views along Charles Street, views from other places towards Charles Street, shifts in the City street grid, changes in topography, and significant historical events.	Entire byway			

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
<u>Neighborhood Context</u> Projects should reinforce positive and desirable urban features that existing within the neighborhood context, including the overall shape, form, and scale of nearby buildings, the predominant architectural styles, the historical significance of the district within which it sits, and the relationship to the street of nearby buildings.				
<u>Streetscape</u> Projects should incorporate street level uses that encourage pedestrian activity, appear safe and inviting, and encourage the use of Charles Street as a multi-modal byway. Incorporate lighting, signage, landscape elements, and other design elements to create an identifiable sense of space along Charles Street.				
<u>Vehicular Access & Parking</u> Integrate parking facilities in a manner that minimizes their visual impact through the use of appropriate architectural treatments or landscape design, and where feasible provides access and internal circulation from side streets or internal alley's.				
Re-invent concrete-more permeable drainage systems. Incorporate "green design throughout" LEEDS category?				
Byway Conservation and Enhancement: GOAL: Maintain and enhance Charles Street's urban forest				
Inventory the location of and establish a GIS data base for managing and maintaining existing urban street trees, urban woodlands, and other elements of Charles Street's green infrastructure.	Entire Byway	City Forest Conservation Project and County DEP		
Work to establish a linear conservation easement along the length of the roadway between University Parkway and Lutherville to protect the green edge of Charles Street	University Parkway to Lutherville			

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Work with utility companies to minimize the impact of overhead utility wires on roadside vegetation. Possible approaches include: - place utility wires underground whenever feasible - use alternative spacer bars on wires to reduce pruning requirements - consider more frequent pruning to create less of a jarring visual impact - use more appropriately size plant materials when working under a utility line - consolidate the number of poles and corridors required by encouraging electric, phone, cable companies to coordinate - prepare landowner/utility company maintenance agreements, if feasible - Create tree registry based on inventory and require trees be pruned by ISA certified arborist and give 3 days notice to property owner and Byway Steward. - Require utility company to contact Byway leadership prior to initiating pruning activities				
Work with City, County, and civic groups to encourage the establishment or continuation of volunteer planting and maintenance programs such as Adopt-a-Highway, roadside vegetation management, urban tree planting and property owner initiated plantings. In the County, approach SHA with proposals for community gateway plantings, reforestation plantings, streetscapes and highway beautification plantings as part of their Partnership Planting Program.	City and County (County)			
Work with City, County, and SHA to develop appropriate urban street tree details that provide ample room for root zones through the use of continuous tree pits, structural soil, and appropriate pavement and utility details.				
Byway Conservation and Enhancement: GOAL: Assist existing groups in their efforts to implement previously planned and programmed enhancement projects for Charles Street				
Complete design and implement Woodbrook Neighborhood	Baltimore			

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Conservation Project as proposed prior to stoppage of program based on funding availability	County			
Work with and support JHU and adjoining neighborhoods in their efforts to establish a distinctive boulevard character between 25 th and University Parkway				
Extend current streetscape efforts from Downtown Phase I and II northward				
I-695 Gateway Enhancement – new project needed to improve the appearance of the Charles Street exit from I-695 in addition to the development of a visitor information kiosk				
South Baltimore Gateway Enhancement – new project needed to improve the appearance of Charles Street at the Wells Street end of the corridor including a visitor information kiosk and more clearly identified linkages to nearby existing and planned visitor facilities (e.g. Fort McHenry and the planned cruise ship terminal (without leading to additional cut through traffic)				
Between Gittings and Bellona Avenues – consider utility relocation or underground and improve appearance				
Byway Conservation and Enhancement:				
GOAL: Work with and support existing groups in their efforts to better maintain public spaces along Charles Street				
Extend the concepts currently in use within the Charles Village Community Benefits District to other neighborhoods along Charles Street.				
Work with neighborhood and civic groups to gain 100% coverage of all of the byway corridor in existing “adopt a street/highway efforts				

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Traveling along the Byway: GOAL: Make the byway a safe, clean, walkable, and pedestrian friendly environment for its entire length				
Improve pedestrian safety by slowing the speed of traffic through the use of traffic calming measures	North of Penn Station on both Charles and St. Paul, priority is Woodbrook			
Install consistent quality of ornamental lighting; and more lighting in general to improve safety – utilize City's preferred fixtures along entire length of byway				
Extend existing streetscape projects north of Mt. Vernon and south of Downtown	- priority location is South Baltimore			
Ensure that there is a continuous sidewalk on both sides of Charles Street from end-to-end along the Byway, that sidewalks are wider, and that there is a buffer between the street and sidewalk	Focus on Stevenson to Bellona, and County line to Hopkins			
Traveling along the Byway: GOAL: Make it easier and safer to travel the byway by bicycle				

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Establish (or re-establish) a clearly marked and signed bicycle route that utilizes shared roadway or on-street bicycle lanes.				
Ensure that all drainage grates, curbs and pavement surfaces are bicycle friendly along Charles and St. Paul				
Provide convenient bicycle storage along Charles Street				
Traveling along the Byway: GOAL: Make it easier and safer to find your way along the byway by automobile by improving signage, wayfinding, and the visual identity of Charles Street				
Bring visitors from I-95 to the visitor center at Inner Harbor as the primary visitor travel route – then provide better linkages from the Visitor Center to Charles Street				
Provide additional wayfinding to connect Fort McHenry to the byway along Key Highway and Fort Street into South Baltimore, and from the Baltimore-Washington Parkway / Russell Street into South Baltimore to Ostend.				
Develop specific byway related “urban pull-offs” that direct visitors to “urban trailheads” and pursue necessary changes to parking (e.g. weekend use). Priority locations include: - South Baltimore - Inner Harbor trailhead (mother of all trailheads) - Mt. Vernon - Penn Station/Falls Road - JHU - Northern Gateway (Lutherville)				
Extend the existing wayfinding system outward from the above mentioned trailheads through the use of subtle visual identification within each distinct district or neighborhood.				

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
As the City upgrades the traffic signals, generally improve the timing of traffic lights along Charles and St. Paul, and ensure that they are set for appropriately slower speed.				
Continue to convert parking meters to pay stations through the entire length of Charles Street				
Make for safer left turn movements to both improve traffic flow and minimize impact on neighborhoods [JHU campus to City Line] and in county.				
Traveling along the Byway: GOAL: Make Charles Street the most "multi-modal" byway in the country				
Prepare a guide to Charles Street by transit – how to get museums, neighborhoods, special districts, and other byway attractions by bus or transit				
Support the further planning and development of the Charles Street Circulator as proposed by the Charles Street Development Corporation				
Promote and develop Charles Street as a safe and attractive visitor connection to Downtown and Inner Harbor for visitors as an overall promotion for visiting Baltimore by Train				
Improve general access to mass transit as an alternative for Charles Street commuters by promoting clean, user-friendly public transit that appeals to residents, tourists, shoppers and workers. <i>Consider the use of smaller buses during off peak hours or defined taxi routes</i>				

Strategy or Action	Location	Responsible Party (SUGGESTED)	Preliminary Budget	Funding Source
Interpreting the Byway GOAL: Tell the story of Baltimore's significant role in enlightened urban development and arc				
° x9 x8 <i>Identify potential interpretive sites and opportunities:</i> ° x1 Mt. Vernon [walking tour starting point] and make it easier and safer to travel the by-way by alternate modes of transportation				



Number Six

Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Enhancing the Visitor Experience

Of the fourteen requirements for corridor management plans that must be met for a scenic road to be designated as a National Scenic Byway, four are specific to enhancing the visitor experience along the Byway:

- A plan to accommodate commerce while maintaining a safe and efficient level of highway service, including convenient user facilities
- A demonstration that intrusions on the visitor experience have been minimized to the extent feasible, and a plan for making improvements to enhance that experience
- A narrative describing how the National Scenic Byway will be positioned for marketing
- A description of plans to interpret the significant resources of the scenic byway

Management strategies aimed at enhancing the visitor experience along the Byway include both wayfinding and interpretation. There are a number of pedestrian oriented wayfinding projects already taking place along the downtown sections of the Byway. Existing walking tours are already being offered that incorporate portions of Charles Street and help tell the story of its development.

Additional walking tours directly related to the theme – urban innovation on the shores of the Chesapeake – need to be further developed. Wayfinding signs need help visitors find visitor facilities

Marketing the Byway should take advantage of Charles Street's multi-



modal access to a wide range of regionally significant historic sites organized around a specific theme.

Preliminary Strategies

It is vitally important to the success of the Byway that visitors can easily find the Byway and the points of interest and features that help to tell the Byway's story in a cohesive way. The attached table identifies a preliminary list of visitor experience strategies designed to make it easier to find and learn about the resources found along the Byway. The following key projects are included in the strategies:

- 1) Make it easier to find the byway in South Baltimore–
 - From I-95 to Key Highway to Fort Avenue into South Baltimore
 - From the Inner Harbor Visitor Center to Cross Street Market via Light Street
 - From the Baltimore-Washington Parkway and Russell Street to the Cross Street Market via West Hamburg Street

- 2) Make it easier to find the Byway from I-695 in Baltimore County and improve the overall quality of the experience of the northern section of the Byway

- Direct Byway visitors from the Baltimore Beltway to a new visitor information kiosk – the location of which is still to be determined (see previous discussion of enhancement strategies and requiring coordination with the Charles Street Interchange/Beltway Widening project
- Direct visitors from the visitor information kiosk to key sites along North Charles (Lutherville, Sheppard Pratt, and others)

- 3) Develop new visitor information kiosks or ensure that existing visitor centers have Byway specific information at key connection points along the byway:

- Cross Street Market in South Baltimore
- the Inner Harbor (existing visitor center)
- Downtown (Charles Center)
- Mt. Vernon Place
- Penn Station
- Johns Hopkins / Baltimore Museum of Art
- the North Charles Gateway

- 4) Develop a series of themed walking tours/itineraries to expand existing offerings along Charles Street originating at locations noted above. The following itineraries are recommended and further described in the attached list of strategies:

- Innovations in Housing: The Row House
- Charles Street's Architectural Icons
- Charles Street's Houses of Worship
- Innovations in Education and Philanthropy

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Number Four

Charles Street Byway Management Plan

Protecting and Promoting the Unique Qualities of the Charles Street Corridor

Preserving and Enhancing the Byway

There are fourteen requirements for corridor management plans that must be met for a scenic road to be designated as a National Scenic Byway. Of the fourteen, five are specific to preservation and enhancement of the byway:

- A map identifying the corridor boundaries and the location of intrinsic qualities and different land uses within the corridor;
- An assessment of such intrinsic qualities and of their context;
- A strategy for maintaining and enhancing those intrinsic qualities;
- A strategy describing how existing development might be enhanced and new development might be accommodated while still preserving the intrinsic qualities of the corridor;
- A demonstration that intrusions on the visitor experience have been minimized to the extent feasible, and a plan for making improvements to enhance that experience.

Charles Street is fortunate in that most of the byway is designated as a series of continuous local and national historic districts. However, only two of the historic districts have adopted guidelines for accommodating new development. Additional efforts will be needed to guide future development in a manner that will be compatible with the intrinsic qualities while being respectful of the individual interests of property owners.

In addition, efforts are needed to accelerate existing planned or programmed enhancement projects to ensure that they are implemented in a

timely manner and to address the issue of the need to minimize intrusions on the visitor experience. Additional strategies are also needed to better maintain the urban forest and green infrastructure along Charles Street, and to improve the overall cleanliness and 'curb appeal' of all the neighborhoods along Charles Street.

Preliminary Strategies

The attached table identifies a preliminary list of preservation and enhancement strategies designed to preserve Charles Street's nationally and regionally significant historic qualities. The strategies also suggest ways for development to be accommodated in a manner that maintains and/or enhances those historic qualities. The strategies are organized according to five key goals:

- Preserve particularly vulnerable and high priority historic structures, sites and landscapes through the use of preservation easements;
- Maintain the overall character and quality of the byway through the use of simple and easy to understand design and development guidelines;
- Maintain and enhance Charles Streets urban forest and green infrastructure;
- Assist existing groups in their efforts to implement previously planned and programmed enhancement projects for Charles Street;
- Work with and support existing groups in their efforts to better maintain public spaces along Charles Street.



Charles Street is distinguished by some of the most important architecture and urban design and planning in America, unified by the landscape and a palate of indigenous building materials that marries the brick clay of the Plain with the rock of the Piedmont. Most significantly, uniquely, and charmingly, the 12 mile length consists of a virtually unbroken series of local and National Register historic districts, including the Mount Vernon Place National Historic Landmark District.

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